



YOUR SMILE CONFIDENCE PROFILE

What a smile makeover actually involves

The plain version, with no sales language: what the treatments are, what they can and cannot do, how long each takes, and how to judge whether someone is any good at this.

The Concealer · A Smile Confidence guide · General information, not dental advice

Start here, because most people are guessing

People who hide their smile have usually spent years avoiding the subject entirely, which means they arrive at a consultation with very little idea what is actually on the table. That is not ignorance. Nobody explains this stuff unless you ask, and asking means admitting the thing bothers you.

So here is the map. There are roughly four levels of cosmetic work, and they differ enormously in cost, permanence, and how much of your own tooth is involved. Whitening changes colour only. Bonding adds tooth-coloured material to fix a chip or close a small gap. Veneers are thin custom facings that change colour, shape, and proportion together. Crowns rebuild a whole tooth and are usually about structure rather than looks.

The one worth understanding properly is veneers, because it is the option most people mean when they say smile makeover, and it is the one with a real trade-off. Most veneers require some enamel to be reduced, which does not grow back. That is not a reason to avoid them. It is a reason to be certain about the plan before anyone starts, which is what the rest of this guide is about.

Six things worth knowing before you go anywhere

These work on any practice. Take them with you wherever you go, including somewhere that is not us.

1 Ask what the plan does to your own teeth

How much enamel comes off, and is the option reversible? Some approaches are much more conservative than others. You are entitled to a straight answer before you agree to anything.

2 Ask to see cases the dentist did themselves

Not stock photography and not lab marketing. Their own patients, ideally someone who started somewhere near where you are. Any cosmetic dentist who enjoys this work will be pleased to be asked.

3 Understand what a trial smile is, and ask for one

A mock-up, sometimes placed temporarily over your own teeth, that lets you see and feel the proposed shape before anything permanent happens. It is the single most useful step in cosmetic dentistry and the one most worth insisting on.

4 Get the sequence, not just the total

Cosmetic plans usually have stages, and some of them are optional or can wait. Ask which parts are structural, which are cosmetic, and what the order is.

5 Ask about the boring parts: lifespan and repair

How long does this typically last, what happens when something chips, and what does maintenance look like in ten years? These questions get skipped and they matter more than the shade does.

6 Say the actual thing that bothers you, out loud

Not "I want them nicer." The colour, the length, the one tooth, the way it looks in photographs. Precision from you is what makes precision possible in the result.

Whitening comes first, almost always. Veneers and bonding are made to a fixed shade and do not lighten later. If whitening is part of your plan it happens before anything permanent is matched to it, and the colour needs a couple of weeks to settle before that match is taken. Getting this order wrong is the most common expensive mistake in cosmetic dentistry.

Signs you are in careful hands, anywhere you go

- You were shown the shape before anything permanent was done
- Someone explained what happens to your own tooth structure, unprompted
- The plan was separated into necessary, cosmetic, and optional
- You were told what maintenance and repair look like years from now
- Nobody needed a decision from you on the day

HOW DR. MEHTA WORKS

A small practice, on purpose

Reflections is two chairs on Crowchild Trail. Dr. Ashish Mehta sees a small number of people, and that is a deliberate choice about how he wants to practise.

Smile design is slow work that looks fast in the photographs. The measuring, the trial, the small adjustments after you have lived with the shape for a few days: that is where the result actually comes from, and it needs appointments a high-volume day does not have room for.

"I see a small number of people, and that is on purpose."

Dr. Ashish Mehta

Bring these to your consultation

Fifteen minutes goes a lot further with a couple of specifics in hand. Turning up with none of them is fine too.

1 A photograph of yourself smiling that you like

Even an old one. It tells a dentist more about what you are aiming at than any description will.

2 A photograph you dislike, if you have one

Equally useful, and often more so. What bothers you in it is the actual brief.

3 The one sentence version of what you want

Write it down beforehand. People who have hidden their smile for years often find it hard to say in the room, and having it on your phone solves that.

Fifteen minutes, free, plus a preview of your smile

Dr. Mehta will talk through what is realistic for your teeth specifically, and you will see a rendered preview of a possible result. Nothing is done to your teeth that day and there is no cost.

Book your free 15 minutes

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Nothing is done to your teeth at this appointment, and there is no cost.

This guide is general information about cosmetic dental treatment. It is not dental advice, it is not a treatment plan, and it is not a comment on any other practice. What is achievable for your teeth depends on an in-person examination, and results differ from person to person. Any images you are shown are an illustration of a possible outcome, not a promise of one. Reflections Dental Group, Calgary, Alberta.